appropriate legislation to fix the problem," Olen says, mimicking financial gurus and the people who swear by them. I am what the youth call "shook."

What I consider "not a lot of money" has changed big time since I got a lump sum of about $50,000 for that TV show Allison and I sold in 2016. When that happened, I managed to put $19,000 into my savings account and told myself I wouldn't touch that money.

I've touched that money. My savings account now fluctuates between $5,000 and $10,000 depending on how closely I'm paying attention to my finances that month or what unexpected or emergency expenses have emerged. If it falls below that range, I stop and consider what I've been overspending on. Then I despair.

In the past, a $50,000 check would have made me feel like one of the Jenners. But now the responsibility of it makes me anxious and confused. I wasn't prepared. So much went to taxes. How did I spend nearly $5,000 in less than six months? Is it only because I had it that I suddenly felt okay to spend it? When I added another $5,000 of it into my retirement fund, I started worrying that it was too soon to start saving so much for retirement. What if I need that money?

You: For what, Gaby?

Me: I don't know. For things.

For almost thirty years, I never even had $5,000 in my bank account *collectively*, and now I've blown through that?! What has changed?

I haven't been buying myself jewels and furs, so what have I been buying? For the first time in my life, in 2017, I clicked on the "Budgeting" tab on my Bank of America account and voilà! There's an actual visual breakdown of my spending! Who knew!?

In the span of a random month in 2017, here were my expenditures:

° $1,239.61 for rent, which isn't bad for a one bedroom in Silverlake. I've lived here alone for 3½ years, something I never thought I'd be able to afford to do and *was* doing technically before I could actually afford to do it. In fact, I've paid my rent late enough times that my landlord